Postures in the Matsyendrasaṃhitā: Chapter Three

Author: Alexander Vijaya (Telegram)

Preface

The Matsyendrasaṃhitā is a Sanskrit tantric treatise on yoga attributed to the siddha Matsyendranātha. Its third paṭala, or chapter, describes fifteen bodily postures, or āsanas. The following presentation includes the Sanskrit text, transliteration in IAST and Cyrillic, word-by-word glosses, literal and literary translations, and notes on difficult passages.

The Sanskrit text is based on Debabrata Sensharma's 1994 edition. Its parentheses, question marks and ellipses are retained. In the translations, square brackets mark explanatory additions or proposed interpretations. An uncertain interpretation is not necessarily an illegible printed word: a form can be clearly printed and still be grammatically difficult.

The work attributes the removal of disease and the attainment of siddhis—perfections or extraordinary powers—to these practices. These are claims made by the historical text, not medical recommendations.

The edition and its manuscript sources

Matsyendrasaṃhitā, ascribed to Matsyendranātha. Part I. Edited by Debabrata Sensharma. Calcutta: The Asiatic Society, 1994. Bibliotheca Indica, no. 318. Digitised edition. Part I contains chapters 1–20 of 55. Chapter 3 appears on Sanskrit text pages 21–25.

The edition is based on a single manuscript known to the editor, held at the Wellcome Institute in London under the shelfmark 2/9/9. According to his description, it is written in Devanāgarī on locally made paper and consists of 120 folios, averaging 22 lines each. Sensharma notes lacunae and omissions and explains that he relied on emendation while leaving some passages in a corrupt form. Three incomplete manuscripts of the same title from the National Archives in Kathmandu, he reports, contained a different work and did not serve as witnesses to this text. Separately from the 1994 edition, P. C. Bagchi published four tantric works attributed to Matsyendranātha.

The readings and marks in a printed edition are not automatically identical to the manuscript: the edition also reflects editorial decisions. See Enrica Garzilli's review for a discussion of the edition.

Dating

The manuscript is undated. Sensharma describes his palaeographic estimate as follows (introduction, p. 1):

> "The ms bears no date but on paleographic examination the date for writing the ms appears to be about 1900 Vikram era corresponding to 1858 A. D."

The conversion given in this sentence is inconsistent: 1900 of the Vikram era corresponds approximately to 1843–44 CE, while 1858 CE corresponds approximately to 1914–15 of that era. The sentence does not establish which number the editor intended. On the Vikram calendar.

The date of the manuscript must be distinguished from the date of composition and from the lifetime attributed to Matsyendranātha. On the range of scholarly opinions about the latter, Sensharma writes (introduction, p. 9):

> "The upper limit of his time is fifth century A. D. and lowest limit is sometime in the thirteenth century A. D."

On p. 26, he offers his own conclusion:

> "Matsyendranātha therefore probably flourished in 5th or 6th century A. D. and lived for 400 years or so in the physical body and taught Yoga to Gorakṣanātha in the 10th century A. D."

This is the editor's interpretation, not an established historical conclusion. The description of Csaba Kiss's critical edition dates the composition tentatively to the thirteenth century and refers to five nineteenth-century witnesses:

> "This volume presents the first critical edition, along with an English translation, of the core chapters of a Sanskrit work of perhaps the thirteenth century surviving in five nineteenth-century witnesses"

Kiss's The Yoga of the Matsyendrasaṃhitā: A Critical Edition and Annotated Translation of Chapters 1–13 and 55 (IFP / EFEO, 2021) includes chapter 3. An accessible description of the book characterises the earlier edition as "partial and extremely unreliable"; its readings should therefore be approached with caution.

Text and numbering

Cyrillic transliteration follows a consistent mapping in which anusvāra is written **ѧ**, with a dot below, and no soft sign is used. IAST represents the Devanāgarī text in Latin characters.

The verses are numbered sequentially here. In the printed edition, the verses numbered here as 9, 19, 29 and 39 bear the numbers ६, १६, २६ and ३६ respectively. A partially repeated verse between 17 and 18 is numbered **18a** in the book. The labels [9a]–[10b] in the edition refer to source folios.

The postures are Vīrāsana, Kūrmāsana, Sudṛḍhāsana, Śvalikāsana (possibly Svastikāsana), Kukkuṭāsana, Mayūrāsana, Vyāghrāsana, Padmāsana, Vijayāsana, Dṛḍhāsana, Gṛdhrāsana, Garuḍāsana, Yakṣāsana, Siddhāsana and Vṛṣabhāsana. The chapter closes with general instructions on practice.

Introduction (verses 1–2)

Devanāgarī

यथासतक्रमं (यथागतक्रम) वक्ष्ये साधकानां हिताय वै । यदभ्यासक्रमेव(यदभ्यासक्रमेणैव) स्थिरत्वं सुकरं भवेत् ॥ १ ॥

IAST

yathāsatakramaṃ (yathāgatakrama) vakṣye sādhakānāṃ hitāya vai |
yadabhyāsakrameva(yadabhyāsakrameṇaiva) sthiratvaṃ sukaraṃ bhavet || 1 ||

Cyrillic transliteration

йатхāсатакрамаṃ (йатхāгатакрама) вакшйе сāдхакāнāṃ хитāйа ваи |
йадабхйāсакрамева(йадабхйāсакрамеṇаива) стхиратваṃ сукараṃ бхавет || 1 ||

Devanāgarī

समादाय शुचौ देशो ....+.....+..... वस्तोत्तरं छदं (?) । शङ्खं च दक्षिणं (दक्षिणे) स्थाप्यं सम्यग् वामोरूमूर्ध्वनि ॥ २ ॥

IAST

samādāya śucau deśo ....+.....+..... vastottaraṃ chadaṃ (?) | śaṅkhaṃ ca dakṣiṇaṃ (dakṣiṇe) sthāpyaṃ samyag vāmorūmūrdhvani || 2 ||

Cyrillic transliteration

самāдāйа ш́учау деш́о ....+.....+..... вастоттараṃ чхадаṃ (?) | ш́аṅкхаṃ ча дакшиṇаṃ (дакшиṇе) стхāпйаṃ самйаг вāморӯмӯрдхвани || 2 ||

Word-by-word analysis

йатхāсат-крамаṃ / йатхāгата-крамаṃ - in the [former] order (there are two readings in the manuscript, “यथासत्क्रमम्” – apparently erroneous); вакшйе - [I] will tell; сāдхакāнāṃ - for practitioners; хитāйа - for the sake of good; ваи - truly; йат-абхйāса-крамеṇаива - precisely [thanks to] gradual practice; стхиратваṃ - stability; сукараṃ - easily accessible; бхавет - becomes.

самāдāйа - having accepted [āsana]; ш́учау - clean; деш́е - location; (...omission in the manuscript...); вāсоттараṃ чхадам (?) - [reading unclear]; ш́аṅкхаṃ - conch; ча - and; дакшиṇаṃ / дакшиṇе - right / on the right (there are two readings in the manuscript); стхāпйаṃ - should be installed; самйак - as it should; вāма-ӯру-ӯрдхвани - on the top of the left thigh.

Literal translation

In the [former] order (there are two readings in the edition: “यथासत्क्रमम्” and “यथागतक्रमम्”) I will tell for the benefit of practitioners; It is through gradual practice that stability becomes easily achievable. Taking [the āsana] in a clean place... (the middle of the verse in the manuscript is omitted) ... and placing the conch [right] properly on the top of the left thigh (the readings “वासोत्तरं छदम्” and “दक्षिणं/दक्षिणे” are not reliable).

Literary translation

Śiva addresses Pārvatī: “For the benefit of practitioners, I shall describe [the postures] in [the former] order (the opening reading is uncertain), for stability is easily achieved through gradual practice. Having assumed a posture in a clean place ... [a passage is missing] ... and properly placed the conch on the upper part of the left thigh ...” The readings in verse 2 are uncertain, including “वासोत्तरं छदम्” and “दक्षिणं/दक्षिणे”.

Note: Verse 2 is badly damaged in the edition: the middle of the line is missing; readings "वासोत्तरं छदम्" and "दक्षिणं/दक्षिणे" are not reliable.

1. Virāsana (“Hero Pose”)

Devanāgarī

सम-ग्रीवशिरोव (कुत्रं) ह (स्तौ) विन्यस्य चोपरि । आकुञ्च्य गुदमेकाग्रो वीरासनमिदं परम् ॥ ३ ॥

IAST

sama-grīvaśirova (kutraṃ) ha (stau) vinyasya copari | ākuñcya gudamekāgro vīrāsanamidaṃ param || 3 ||

Cyrillic transliteration

сама-грӣваш́ирова (кутраṃ) ха (стау) винйасйа чопари | ākuñчйа гудамекāгро вӣрāсанамидаṃ парам || 3 ||

Devanāgarī

अनेन आसनयोगेन योगरूढः प्रसिध्यति । न चाभ्यासविधौ वैतच्छेत्स्यति सर्वसिद्धये ॥ ४ ॥

IAST

anena āsanayogena yogarūḍhaḥ prasidhyati | na cābhyāsavidhau vaitacchetsyati sarvasiddhaye || 4 ||

Cyrillic transliteration

анена āсанайогена йогарӯ́дхаḥ прасидхйати | на чāбхйāсавидхау ваитаччхетсйати сарвасиддхайе || 4 ||

Word-by-word analysis

сама-грӣва-ш́ираḥ - with the neck and head aligned (in the edition: “सम-ग्रीवशिरोव (कुत्रं) ह (स्तौ)” - the reading is corrupt); хастау - both hands; винйасйа - placing; ча - and; упари - over [knees]; ākuñчйа - tucking; гудам - anus; екāграḥ - unidirectional (in the manuscript together: “गुदमेकाग्रो”); вӣрāсанам - Vīrāsana; идаṃ - this one; парам - highest.

анена - this one; āсана-йогена - practice of this āsana (yoga poses); йога-рӯ́дхаḥ - established in yoga; прасидхйати - achieves perfection; на - no; ча - and; абхйāса-видхау - concerning the method of practice (the edition reads “विधौ”; the syntax remains uncertain); ваи - truly; тат-чхетсйати - will discard that; сарва-сиддхайе - for the sake of all siddhis.

Literal translation

With the neck and head aligned (the reading of the beginning of the line in the manuscript is corrupt), hands placed on top of [the knees], tucked in the anus, with the mind directed towards the one (in the manuscript “गुदमेकाग्रो”) – [the yogi resides] in this highest Vīrāsana. Through the practice of this āsana, he, established in yoga, achieves perfection; and for the sake of [gaining] all siddhis he will truly not abandon the method of practice.

Literary translation

With neck and head upright (the beginning of the verse is corrupt), hands placed on the knees, the anus contracted and the mind focused on a single point, the yogin remains in this supreme posture. Through its practice he attains perfection in yoga; for the sake of all siddhis he never abandons the practice.

2. Kurmāsana (“Turtle Pose”)

Devanāgarī

तस्यैव (तस्यैवं) दक्षिणां जङ्घां न्यसेद् वामोरूमूर्धके कूर्मासनं तद्विज्ञेयं सर्वेद्रिवशंकरं (सर्वेन्द्रियवशं करम्) ॥ ५ ॥

IAST

tasyaiva (tasyaivaṃ) dakṣiṇāṃ jaṅghāṃ nyased vāmorūmūrdhake kūrmāsanaṃ tadvijñeyaṃ sarvedrivaśaṃkaraṃ (sarvendriyavaśaṃ karam) || 5 ||

Cyrillic transliteration

тасйаива (тасйаиваṃ) дакшиṇāṃ джаṅгхāṃ нйасед вāморӯмӯрдхаке кӯрмāсанаṃ тадвиджн̃ейаṃ сарведривашаṃкараṃ (сарвендрийавашаṃ карам) || 5 ||

Word-by-word analysis

тасйаива / тасйаиваṃ - for the same [pose] (there are two readings in the manuscript); дакшиṇāṃ джаṅгхāṃ - right shin; нйасед - let him place it; вāма-ӯру-ӯрдхаке - on the top of the left thigh; кӯрмāсанам - Kūrmāsana; тат - that [pose]; виджн̃ейаṃ - let it be known; сарва-индрийа-вашаṃкарам - making all senses subordinate (in the edition: “सर्वेद्रिवशंकरं”).

Literal translation

In the same [pose] (there are two readings in the edition: “तस्यैव” / “तस्यैवम्”) let him place the right shin on the top of the left thigh. That [pose] should be known as Kūrmāsana, which subjugates all the senses.

Literary translation

From the preceding position, place the right lower leg on the upper part of the left thigh. The posture is said to bring all the senses under control. The opening reading is uncertain.

3. Sudrdhāsana (“Very strong pose”)

Devanāgarī

दक्षपादं च वामोरू मूले विन्यस्य तत्पदम् । दक्षोरुमूलपीठार्थं कल्पयेत् सुदृढासनम् ॥ ६ ॥

IAST

dakṣapādaṃ ca vāmorū mūle vinyasya tatpadam | dakṣorumūlapīṭhārthaṃ kalpayet sudṛḍhāsanam || 6 ||

Cyrillic transliteration

дакшапāдаṃ ча вāморӯ мӯле винйасйа татпадам | дакшорумӯлапӣṭхāртхаṃ калпайет судр̣д̣хāсанам || 6 ||

Word-by-word analysis

дакша-пāдаṃ - right foot; ча - and; вāма-ӯру-мӯле - at the root of the left thigh; винйасйа - placing; тат-падам - that foot; дакша-ӯру-мӯла-пӣṭхāртхаṃ - [using it] as a seat (support) for the root of the right thigh; калпайет - let him create; судр̣д̣хāсанам - Sudridhasan.

Literal translation

Placing the right foot at the root of the left thigh - [using] that foot as a support for the root of the right thigh - let him create Sudṛḍhāsana.

Literary translation

Place the right foot at the root of the left thigh so that it serves as a support or seat for the root of the right thigh as well.

4. Shvalikāsana (“Swastika Pose”? – the name is uncertain in the edition)

Devanāgarī

बाहुयुग्मं समुसृज्य श्वलिका (?) - सनमीरितम् । सर्वसिद्धिप्रदं देवि सर्वरोगविनाशनम् ॥ ७ ॥

IAST

bāhuyugmaṃ samusṛjya śvalikā (?) - sanamīritam | sarvasiddhipradaṃ devi sarvarogavināśanam || 7 ||

Cyrillic transliteration

бāхуйугмаṃ самусṛджйа ш́валикā (?) - санамӣритам | сарвасиддхипрадаṃ деви сарварогавинāш́анам || 7 ||

Word-by-word analysis

бāху-йугмаṃ - a pair of hands; самусṛджйа - releasing [freely] (in the edition: “समुसृज्य”); ш́валикā (?) - sanam īritam - [the name of the pose in the manuscript is damaged]; сарва-сиддхи-прадаṃ - bestower of all siddhis; деви - O Goddess; сарва-рога-винāш́анам - destroying all diseases.

Literal translation

Freely releasing both hands [along the body] - [this] is proclaimed ... (the name of the pose in the manuscript is damaged) ..., O Goddess, bestowing all siddhis and destroying all diseases.

Literary translation

Let both arms hang freely. The name of the posture in the reading reproduced here is damaged (“श्वलिका (?) - सन”). It is said to confer all siddhis and destroy all diseases. The summary of the chapter in the 1994 edition identifies the posture as Svastikāsana; this identification remains uncertain.

Note: The name of the pose in the printed reading is uncertain (“श्वलिकासन”); in Paṭala's summary in the publication she is listed as Svastikāsana.

5. Kukkutāsana (“Rooster Pose”)

Devanāgarī

वामगुल्फमधः कृत्वा कृत्वोपरि च दक्षिणम् । गुदेनापीड्य वै जानुयुगलं परिपाल्य च ॥ ८ ॥

IAST

vāmagulphamadhaḥ kṛtvā kṛtvopari ca dakṣiṇam | gudenāpīḍya vai jānuyugalaṃ paripālya ca || 8 ||

Cyrillic transliteration

вāмагулпхамадхаҳ кр̣твā кр̣твопари ча дакшиṇам | гуденāпӣдйа ваи джāнуйугалаṃ парипāлйа ча || 8 ||

Devanāgarī

वामहस्ताङ्गुलीमूले (मूल) - मवष्टभ्य यथाबलम् । दक्षिणहस्ताङ्गुलीमूलैः परिवर्त्य च तत्तलौ ॥ ९ ॥

IAST

vāmahastāṅgulīmūle (mūla) - mavaṣṭabhya yathābalam | dakṣiṇahastāṅgulīmūlaiḥ parivartya ca tattalau || 9 ||

Cyrillic transliteration

вāмахастāṅгулӣмӯле (мӯла) - мавашṭабхйа йатхāбалам | дакшиṇахастāṅгулӣмӯлаиҳ паривартйа ча татталау || 9 ||

Devanāgarī

कुरूमूलद्वये (उरूमूलद्वये) पीड्य स्थानाग्रे स्थापये (द) दृशौ । कुक्कुटासनमेतद्वै मनसः स्थिरकारणम् ॥ १० ॥

IAST

kurūmūladvaye (urūmūladvaye) pīḍya sthānāgre sthāpaye (da) dṛśau | kukkuṭāsanametadvai manasaḥ sthirakāraṇam || 10 ||

Cyrillic transliteration

курӯмӯладвайе (урӯмӯладвайе) пӣдйа стхāнāгре стхāпайе (да) др̣ш́ау | куккуṭāсанаметадваи манасаҳ стхиракāраṇам || 10 ||

Word-by-word analysis

вāма-гулпхам - left ankle; адхаҳ - down; кр̣твā - placing; упари - top; ча - and; дакшиṇам - right; гудена-āпӣдйа - pressing with/by the anus; the syntax and intended action remain uncertain (edition: “गुदेनापीड्य”); ваи - truly; джāну-йугалаṃ - a pair of knees; парипāлйа - holding [closed]; ча - and.

вāма-хаста-аṅгулӣ-мӯле - at the bases of the fingers of the left hand; авашṭабхйа - leaning (in the edition: “मवष्टभ्य”); йатхāбалам - with all your might; дакшиṇа-хаста-аṅгулӣ-мӯлаиҳ - at the bases of the fingers of the right hand; паривартйа - turning; ча - and; тат-талау - those two palms.

ӯру-мӯла-двайе - on both roots of the thighs (in the edition: “कुरूमूलद्वये”); пӣдйа - squeezing; стхāнāгре - [lit. “at the forefront of [its] place”, the meaning is unclear]; стхāпайет - let him place it (in the edition: “स्थापये (द)”); др̣ш́ау - both [looks]; куккуṭāсанам - Kukkuṭāsana; етат - this one; ваи - truly; манасаҳ - mind; стхира-кāраṇам is the reason for stability.

Literal translation

Placing the left ankle down and the right one on top [of it], [pressing with/by the anus; syntax uncertain] (edition: “गुदेनापीड्य”) and holding the knees together, leaning with all your strength on the bases of the fingers of the left hand and on the bases of the fingers of the right hand, turning both palms, - [further: “स्थानाग्रे स्थापये (द) दृशौ” – lit. “let him place both [gazes] at the forefront of [his] place”, the meaning is unclear] -. This Kukkuṭāsana is truly the cause of mental stability.

Literary translation

Place the left ankle below and the right above, and hold the knees together. The meaning and syntax of gudenāpīḍya remain uncertain. The body rests on the bases of the fingers of both hands, with the palms turned. The meaning of “स्थानाग्रे” in verse 10 is unclear. This posture is said to make the mind steady.

Note: Verse 10 “स्थानाग्रे” – lit. “at the forefront of [its] place”; the meaning is unclear, there is no need to speculate.

6. Mayurāsana (“Peacock Pose”)

Devanāgarī

उरूमूलद्वयाद् अधस्तात् पादयुग्मं निधाय च । तयोर्मध्ये स्थिरगुद पृच्छनुचम्य (?) निश्चलः ॥ ११ ॥

IAST

urūmūladvayād adhastāt pādayugmaṃ nidhāya ca | tayormadhye sthiraguda pṛcchanucamya (?) niścalaḥ || 11 ||

Cyrillic transliteration

урӯмӯладвайād адхастāт пādайугмаṃ нидхāйа ча | тайормадхйе стхирагуда пṛччханучамйа (?) ниш́чалаḥ || 11 ||

Devanāgarī

तथा करतलद्वन्दं समा - (श्लि) - ष्य परस्परम् । उर्वोरुपरि विन्यस्य नासिकामवलोकयेत् ॥ १२ ॥

IAST

tathā karataladvandaṃ samā - (śli) - ṣya parasparam | urvorupari vinyasya nāsikāmavalokayet || 12 ||

Cyrillic transliteration

татхā караталадвандаṃ самā - (ш́ли) - шйа параспарам | урворупари винйасйа нāсикāмавалокайет || 12 ||

Devanāgarī

मयूरासनमेतद् वै सर्वव्याधिविनासनम् ('विनाशनम्) । एतस्य बाहुयुगलं कारयेद् दण्ड- (युग्म) - वत् ॥ १३ ॥

IAST

mayūrāsanametad vai sarvavyādhivināsanam ('vināśanam) | etasya bāhuyugalaṃ kārayed daṇḍa- (yugma) - vat || 13 ||

Cyrillic transliteration

майӯра̄санаметад ваи сарвавйа̄дхивина̄санам ('вина̄ш́анам) | етасйа ба̄хуйугалам̣ ка̄райед даṇд̣а- (йугма) - ват || 13 ||

Word-by-word analysis

ӯру-мӯла-двайа̄т - from both roots of the thighs; адхастāт - below; пада-йугмам̣ - both feet; нидха̄йа - placing; ча - and; тайоҳ - between them; мадхйе - in the middle; стхира-гуд̣а - [with] a stable anus (in the edition: “स्थिरगुद”); пр̣ччханучамйа (?) - [unreadable]; ниш́чалаҳ - stationary.

татха̄ - the same; кара-тала-двандвам̣ - a pair of palms; сама̄-ш́лишйа - folding [together] (in the edition: “समा-(श्लि)-ष्य”); параспарам - with each other; ӯрвоҳ - hips; упари - on top; винйасйа - placing; на̄сика̄м - on the [tip] of the nose; авалокайет - let him look.

майӯра̄санам - Mayūrāsana; етат - this one; ваи - truly; сарва-вйа̄дхи-вина̄ш́анам - destroying all diseases (in the edition: “विनासनम्”, option “विनाशनम्”); етасйа - her; ба̄ху-йугалам̣ - a pair of hands; ка̄райет - let him do it; даṇд̣а-йугмават - similar to a pair of sticks (rods).

Literal translation

Having placed both feet below both roots of the thighs and, motionless, with a stable anus between them - (further the word in the edition is difficult to interpret: “पृच्छनुचम्य (?)”) - also having folded a pair of palms with each other and placing [them] on top of the thighs, let him look at the [tip of] the nose. This is Mayūrāsana, truly destroying all diseases; Let him make the pair of arms like a pair of rods.

Literary translation

Place the feet beneath the roots of the thighs, keep the anus steady and the body motionless; a word in verse 11 is unclear. Place the joined palms on the thighs, look towards the tip of the nose, and keep the arms straight like rods. The posture is said to destroy all diseases.

Note: The word "पृच्छनुचम्य" in the middle of verse 11 is difficult to interpret in the edition.

7. Vyāghrāsana (“Tiger Pose”)

Devanāgarī

करद्वयतलं भूमौ पुटाकारं निधापयेत् । किञ्चि (द्) दानमिततनु निश्चलस्थिरमानमः (° मानसः) ॥ १४ ॥

IAST

karadvayatalaṃ bhūmau puṭākāraṃ nidhāpayet | kiñci (d) dānamitatanu niścalasthiramānamaḥ (° mānasaḥ) || 14 ||

Cyrillic transliteration

карадвайаталам̣ бхӯмау пут̣а̄ка̄рам̣ нидха̄пайет | кин̃чи (д) да̄намитатану ниш́чаластхирама̄намаҳ (° ма̄насаҳ) || 14 ||

Devanāgarī

पुरोवलोकयेद् द्वाभ्यां (स) मग्रीवः समाहितः । व्याघ्रासनमिदं सद्यो व्याधिनं योगसिद्धिदम् ॥ १५ ॥

IAST

purovalokayed dvābhyāṃ (sa) magrīvaḥ samāhitaḥ | vyāghrāsanamidaṃ sadyo vyādhinaṃ yogasiddhidam || 15 ||

Cyrillic transliteration

пуровалокайед двāбхйāṃ (са) магрӣваḥ самāхитаḥ | вйāгхрāсанамидаṃ садйо вйāдхинаṃ йогасиддхидам || 15 ||

Word-by-word analysis

кара-двайа-талаṃ - palms of both hands; бхӯмау - to the ground; путāкāраṃ - [folded] in the form of a bowl (cavity); нидхāпайет - let him place it; кин̃чид - slightly (in the edition: "किञ्चि (द्)"); дāнамитатану (?) - [unreadable]; ниш́чала-стхира-мāнасаḥ - with a motionless and stable mind (in the edition: "मानमः", variant "मानसः").

пураḥ - forward; авалокайет - let him look; двāбхйāṃ - with both [eyes]; сама-грӣваḥ - with the neck aligned (in the edition: "(स) मग्रीवः"); самāхитаḥ - concentrated; вйāгхрāсанам - Vyāghrāsana; идаṃ - this; садйаḥ - immediately; вйāдхӣнāṃ - diseases (in the edition: "व्याधिनं"); йога-сиддхидам - bestowing yoga-siddhi.

Literal translation

Let him place the palms of both hands on the ground, [folded] in the shape of a bowl; … (the middle of the verse in the edition is difficult to interpret: "किञ्चि (द्) दानमिततनु") … with a still and steady mind (in the edition: "मानमः (° मानसः)"), with the neck straight, focused, let him look forward with both [eyes]. This Vyāghrāsana immediately bestows yoga-siddhi [and eliminates] diseases.

Literary translation

Place the palms on the ground in a cupped shape. The middle of verse 14 is unclear. With a steady mind and the neck upright, look forward. The posture is said to confer perfection in yoga and remove disease; the latter rendering relies on an uncertain passage.

Note: In verse 14 the word "दानमिततनु" is not read; reading "मानमः (° मानसः)" is doubled.

8. Padmāsana ("Lotus Pose")

Devanāgarī

वामपादम् अथोत्तानं कृत्वा दक्षोरुमण्डले । दक्षपादं तु वामोरौ तथाभूतं निधापयेत् ॥ १६ ॥

IAST

vāmapādam athottānaṃ kṛtvā dakṣorumaṇḍale | dakṣapādaṃ tu vāmorau tathābhūtaṃ nidhāpayet || 16 ||

Cyrillic transliteration

вāмапāдам атхоттāнаṃ кр̣твā дакшорумаṇдале | дакшапāдаṃ ту вāморау татхāбхӯтаṃ нидхāпайет || 16 ||

Devanāgarī

उरुभ्यामुपरि स्थाप्य बाहुं त्यज्य (न्यस्य ?) यथार्थतः । करपृष्टं दक्ष्यास्य (दक्षस्यास्य) न्यसेद् वामतलान्तरे । अजु (ऋजु) ग्रीवशिरो भूत्वा तथाभूतं निधापयेत् ॥ १७ ॥

IAST

urubhyāmupari sthāpya bāhuṃ tyajya (nyasya ?) yathārthataḥ | karapṛṣṭaṃ dakṣyāsya (dakṣasyāsya) nyased vāmatalāntare | aju (ṛju) grīvaśiro bhūtvā tathābhūtaṃ nidhāpayet || 17 ||

Cyrillic transliteration

урубхйāмупари стхāпйа бāхуṃ тйаджйа (нйасйа ?) йатхāртхатаḥ | карапṛштаṃ дакшйāсйа (дакшасйāсйа) нйасед вāматалāнтаре | аджу (ṛджу) грйваш́иро бхӯтвā татхāбхӯтаṃ нидхāпайет || 17 ||

Devanāgarī

उरूभ्यामुपरि स्थाप्य बाहुं त्यज्य (न्यस्य) यथार्थतः । करपृष्टं दक्ष्यास्य (दक्षस्यास्य) न्यसेद् वामतलान्तरे ॥ १८a ॥

IAST

urūbhyāmupari sthāpya bāhuṃ tyajya (nyasya) yathārthataḥ | karapṛṣṭaṃ dakṣyāsya (dakṣasyāsya) nyased vāmatalāntare || 18a ||

Cyrillic transliteration

урӯбхйāмупари стхāпйа бāхуṃ тйаджйа (нйасйа) йатхāртхатаḥ | карапршṭаṃ дакшйāсйа (дакшасйāсйа) нйасед вāматалāнтаре || 18a ||

Devanāgarī

ऋजुग्रीवशिरो भूत्वा नासिकामवलोकयेत् । तन्निमीलनं चोन्मील (न) म् कुर्यादाकुञ्च्य वै गुदम् ॥ १८ ॥

IAST

ṛjugrīvaśiro bhūtvā nāsikāmavalokayet | tannimīlanaṃ conmīla (na) m kuryādākuñcya vai gudam || 18 ||

Cyrillic transliteration

ṛджугрйваш́иро бхӯтвā нāсикāмавалокайет | таннимӣланаṃ чонмӣла (на) м курйāдāкуйчйа ваи гудам || 18 ||

Devanāgarī

समदेहस्थिरमतिः पद्मासनमिदं पदम् । सर्वयोगप्रसिद्ध्यर्थमभ्यस्तं भवति प्रिये ॥ १९ ॥

IAST

samadehasthiramatiḥ padmāsanamidaṃ padam | sarvayogaprasiddhyarthamabhyastaṃ bhavati priye || 19 ||

Cyrillic transliteration

самадехастхираматиḥ падмāсанамидаṃ падам | сарвайогапрасиддхйартхамабхйастаṃ бхавати прийе || 19 ||

Word-by-word analysis

вāма-пāдаṃ - left foot; атха - then; уттāнаṃ - facing upward [sole]; кṛтвā - having done; дакша-ӯру-маṇḍале - in the area of the right thigh; дакша-пāдаṃ - right foot; ту - same; вāма-ӯрау - on the left thigh; татхāбхӯтаṃ - in the same way [located]; нидхāпайет - let him place it.

урубхйāṃ - hips; упари - on top; стхāпйа - placing [hands]; бāхуṃ - hand; тйаджйа / нйасйа - releasing / placing (in the manuscript fluctuating readings: "त्यज्य (न्यस्य ?)"); йатхāртхатаḥ - as it should; кара-пр̣шт̣хаṃ - back of the hand; дакшасйа - right [hand] (in the edition: “दक्ष्यास्य (दक्षस्यास्य)”); нйасед - let him place it; вāма-тала-антаре - inside the left palm; р̣джу-грӣва-ш́ираḥ - with straightened neck and head (in the edition: “अजु (ऋजु)”); бхӯтвā - becoming; татхāбхӯтаṃ - in the same way [located]; нидхāпайет - let him place it.

урубхйāм упари стхāпйа бāхуṃ тйаджйа (нйасйа) йатхāртхатаḥ - as in verse 17 (line repeated in manuscript); кара-пр̣шт̣хаṃ - back of the hand; дакшасйа - right [hand]; нйасед - let him place it; вāма-тала-антаре - inside the left palm.

р̣джу-грӣва-ш́ираḥ - with straightened neck and head; бхӯтвā - becoming; нāсикāм - on the [tip] of the nose; авалокайет - let him look; тат-нимӣланаṃ - his closing [eyes]; ча - and; унмӣланаṃ - opening (in the edition: “चोन्मील (न) म्”); курйāт - let him do it;ākuñчйа - tucking; ваи - truly; гудам - anus.

сама-деха-стхира-матиḥ - [one whose] body is aligned and the mind is stable; падмāсанам - Padmāsana; идаṃ is; падам - position; сарва-йога-прасиддхйартхам - for the sake of perfection in all yogas; абхйастаṃ - [it] should be practiced; бхавати - [she] is; прийе - oh beloved.

Literal translation

Having made the left foot facing upward [the sole] and placing it in the area of the right thigh, let him place the right foot on the left thigh in the same way. Having placed [the hands] on top of the hips and lowered them as they should (in the manuscript the fluctuating readings are “त्यज्य (न्यस्य ?)”), let him place the back of the hand of the right [hand] (in the edition: “दक्ष्यास्य (दक्षस्यास्य)”) inside the left palm. With his neck and head straightened… (the line "ऋजुग्रीवशिरो भूत्वा..." in verses 17-18 is duplicated) … let him look at the [tip of] his nose; Let him close and open [the eyes] by squeezing his anus (in the edition: “चोन्मील (न) म्”). For one whose body is aligned and whose mind is stable, this position is Padmāsana; for the sake of perfection in all yogas it should be practiced, O beloved.

Literary translation

Place the left foot, sole upward, on the right thigh, and the right foot on the left thigh. The arms rest on the thighs, with the back of the right hand in the left palm; “त्यज्य/न्यस्य” is uncertain. Keep the neck and head upright, look towards the tip of the nose and contract the anus, closing and opening the eyes. The posture is practised for perfection in yoga. Lines in verses 17–18 are partly repeated in the source.

Note: The block contains verses 16, 17, 18a, 18, and 19; verse 18a repeats the first line of verse 17. The line “ऋजुग्रीवशिरो भूत्वा…” occurs in verse 17 and is repeated in verse 18—the text is duplicated in the edition.

9. Vijayāsana (“Victory Pose”)

Devanāgarī

वामजङ्घोपरि स्थाप्य दक्षजङ्घां जितेन्द्रियः । दक्षजङ्घाधरे वामगुल्फपार्श्वं निधापयेत् ॥ २० ॥

IAST

vāmajaṅghopari sthāpya dakṣajaṅghāṃ jitendriyaḥ | dakṣajaṅghādhare vāmagulphapārśvaṃ nidhāpayet || 20 ||

Cyrillic transliteration

вāмаджаṅгхопари стхāпйа дакшаджаṅгхāṃ джитендрийаḥ | дакшаджаṅгхāдхаре вāмагулпхапāрш́ваṃ нидхāпайет || 20 ||

Devanāgarī

हस्तादिनाभिपर्यन्तं पद्मासनवदाचरेत् । विजयासनमेतद्धि सर्वसिद्धिकरं परम् ॥ २१ ॥

IAST

hastādināhiparyantaṃ padmāsanavadācaret | vijayāsanametaddhi sarvasiddhikaraṃ param || 21 ||

Cyrillic transliteration

хастāдинāбхипарйантаṃ падмāсанавадāчарет | виджайāсанаметаддхи сарвасиддхикараṃ парам || 21 ||

Word-by-word analysis

вāма-джаṅгха-упари - over the left shin; стхāпйа - placing; дакша-джаṅгхāṃ - right shin; джита-индрийаḥ - curbed feelings; дакша-джаṅгхā-адхаре - under the [lower part] of the right shin; вāма-гулпха-пāрш́ваṃ - side of the left ankle; нидхāпайет - let him place it.

хастāди-нāбхи-парйантаṃ - starting from the hands [to] the navel; падмāсанават - as in Padmāsana; āчарет - let it act; виджайāсанам - Vijayāsana; етат - this one; хи - for; сарва-сиддхи-караṃ - bestower of all siddhi; парам - highest.

Literal translation

Having placed the right shin on top of the left shin, having curbed the senses, let him bring the side of the left ankle under the [lower part of] the right shin. From the hands to the navel let it act as in Padmāsana. This Vijayāsana, because [it] is the highest, bestows all siddhis.

Literary translation

Cross the legs with the right lower leg over the left, placing the side of the left ankle beneath the right lower leg. From the hands to the navel, proceed as in Padmāsana. The posture is said to confer all siddhis.

10. Drdhāsana (“Strong Pose”)

Devanāgarī

उरुभ्यामुपरि स्थाप्य पादयुग्मं प्रयत्नतः । दक्षिणं सव्यदेशे च सव्यं दक्षिणदेशके ॥ २२ ॥

IAST

urubhyāmupari sthāpya pādayugmaṃ prayatnataḥ | dakṣiṇaṃ savyadeśe ca savyaṃ dakṣiṇadeśake || 22 ||

Cyrillic transliteration

урубхйāмупари стхāпйа пāдайугмаṃ прайатнатаҳ | дакшиṇаṃ савйадеш́е ча савйаṃ дакшиṇадеш́аке || 22 ||

Devanāgarī

करद्वयं पृष्ठदेशे परिवर्त्य प्रयत्नतः । पादांगुष्ठयुगं सम्यक् कराभ्यां संनिगृह्य च ॥ २३ ॥

IAST

karadvayaṃ pṛṣṭhadeśe parivartya prayatnataḥ | pādāṃguṣṭhayugaṃ samyak karābhyāṃ saṃnigṛhya ca || 23 ||

Cyrillic transliteration

карадвайаṃ пṛшṭхадеш́е паривартйа прайатнатаҳ | пāдāṃгушṭхайугаṃ самйак карāбхйāṃ саṃнигṛхйа ча || 23 ||

Devanāgarī

किञ्चिदुत्तानहृदयो नासिकामवलोकयेत् । दृढासनमिदं प्रोक्तं सद्यो रोगविनाशनम् ॥ २४ ॥

IAST

kiñciduttānahṛdayo nāsikāmavalokayet | dṛḍhāsanamidaṃ proktaṃ sadyo rogavināśanam || 24 ||

Cyrillic transliteration

кийчидуттāнахṛдайо нāсикāмавалокайет | дṛдхāсанамидаṃ проктаṃ садйо рогавинāш́анам || 24 ||

Word-by-word analysis

урубхйāṃ - hips; упари - on top; стхāпйа - having placed (the edition reads “स्थाप्य”); пāда-йугмаṃ - both feet; прайатнатаҳ - with force; дакшиṇаṃ - right; савйа-деш́е - on the left side; ча - and; савйаṃ - left; дакшиṇа-деш́аке - on the right side.

кара-двайаṃ - both hands; пṛшṭха-деш́е - in the back area; паривартйа - turned [behind]; прайатнатаҳ - with force; пāда-аṅгушṭха-йугаṃ - a pair of big toes; самйак - good; карāбхйāṃ - with both hands; саннигṛхйа - capturing; ча - and.

кийчид - slightly; уттāна-хṛдайаҳ - with raised chest ('heart'); нāсикāм - on the [tip] of the nose; авалокайет - let him look; дṛдхāсанам - Dṛḍhāsana; идаṃ - this one; проктаṃ - proclaimed; садйаҳ - immediately; рога-винāш́анам - destroying diseases.

Literal translation

With an effort, placing both feet on top of the hips - the right one on the left side, and the left one on the right - and turning both hands behind the back, with an effort, firmly grasping a pair of big toes with both hands, with a slightly raised chest, let him look at the [tip] of the nose. This [posture] is proclaimed Dṛḍhāsana, which immediately destroys diseases.

Literary translation

Place the feet on opposite thighs, take the hands behind the back and grasp the big toes. Raise the chest slightly and look towards the tip of the nose. The posture is said to destroy disease immediately.

11. Grdhrāsana (“Kite Pose”)

Devanāgarī

एतस्याङ्गुष्ठयोर्मूले कर्पूरे (कुपरे) सन्निवेशयेत् । परिवर्त्य करौ स्पृष्टावङ्गुलीतल - गोपिता ॥ २५ ॥

IAST

etasyāṅguṣṭhayormūle karpūre (kupare) sanniveśayet | parivartya karau spṛṣṭāvaṅgulītala - gopitā || 25 ||

Cyrillic transliteration

етасйāṅгушṭхайормӯле карпӯре (купаре) саннивеш́айет | паривартйа карау спṛшṭāваṅгулӣтала - гопитā || 25 ||

Devanāgarī

अङ्गुलीपृष्ठयो हेतु चिबुकं सन्निधापयेत् । अङ्गुष्ठौ सरलौ कृत्वा तालुमूलसमाश्रितौ ॥ २६ ॥

IAST

aṅgulīpṛṣṭhayo hetu cibukaṃ sannidhāpayet | aṅguṣṭhau saralau kṛtvā tālumūlasamāśritau || 26 ||

Cyrillic transliteration

аṅгулӣпṛшṭхайо хету чибукаṃ саннидхāпайет | аṅгушṭхау саралау кṛтвā тāлумӯласамāш́ритау || 26 ||

Devanāgarī

धृत्वा स्थिरमना भूत्वा गृध्रासनमिदं परम् । सर्वदोषक्षयकरं सर्वोपद्रवनाशनम् ॥ २७ ॥

IAST

dhṛtvā sthiramanā bhūtvā gṛdhrāsanamidaṃ param | sarvadoṣakṣayakaraṃ sarvopadravanāśanam || 27 ||

Cyrillic transliteration

дхṛтвā стхираманā бхӯтвā гṛдхрāсанамидаṃ парам | сарвадошакшайакараṃ сарвопадраванāш́анам || 27 ||

Word-by-word analysis

тасйа - his/her; аṅгушṭхайоḥ - thumbs; мӯле - at the roots; карпӯра (купера) (?) - [unreadable]; саннивеш́айет - let him place it; паривартйа - turning; карау - hands (in the edition: “करौ”); спṛшṭвā - touching; аṅгулӣ-тала-гопитā - [fingers] hidden by the palms (reading is not entirely reliable).

аṅгулӣ-пṛшṭхайоḥ - on the backs of the fingers (in the edition: “पृष्ठयो हेतु” - the reading is corrupt); чибукаṃ - chin; саннидхāпайет - let him place it; аṅгушṭхау - thumbs; саралау - straight; кṛтвā - having done; тāлу-мӯла-самāш́ритау - resting at the root of the palate.

дхṛтвā - holding [this position]; стхира-манā - with a stable mind; бхӯтвā - becoming; гṛдхрāсанам - Gṛdhrāsana; идаṃ - this one; парам - highest; сарва-доша-кшайа-караṃ - destroying all vices; сарва-упадрава-нāш́анам - eliminating all disasters.

Literal translation

At the roots of his thumbs let him place … (the edition reads “कर्पूरे (कुपरे)”; its meaning is uncertain) …; turning the hands (in the edition: “करौ”), touching [them]… (further in the edition: “अङ्गुलीतल-गोपिता” - reading is not entirely reliable). And on the backs of the fingers (in the edition: “अङ्गुलीपृष्ठयो हेतु” - the reading is corrupt) let him place the chin, making the thumbs straight - resting at the root of the palate. Holding [this], becoming with a steady mind, [he abides] in this supreme Gṛdhrāsana, which destroys all vices and removes all calamities.

Literary translation

The beginning is damaged: “कर्पूरे (कुपरे)” and other readings are uncertain. The passage refers to the chin, fingers and the root of the palate, but the relationships between them are uncertain. Hold the posture with a steady mind. It is said to destroy defects and afflictions.

Note: Verse 25 is badly damaged: the meaning of “कर्पूरे (कुपरे)” is uncertain; readings "अङ्गुलीतल-गोपिता" and "अङ्गुलीपृष्ठयो हेतु" are unreliable.

12. Garuḍāsana (“Garuda Pose”)

Devanāgarī

वामगुल्फकपृष्ठे तु दक्षगुल्फं निधापयेत् । पातयित्वा महेशानि जानुयुग्मं महीतले ॥ २८ ॥

IAST

vāmagulphakapṛṣṭhe tu dakṣagulphaṃ nidhāpayet | pātayitvā maheśāni jānuyugmaṃ mahītale || 28 ||

Cyrillic transliteration

вāмагулпхакапр̣шт̣хе ту дакшагулпхаṃ нидхāпайет | пāтайитвā махеш́āни джāнуйугмаṃ махӣтале || 28 ||

Devanāgarī

उर्वोः कुर्परमाधाय कृताञ्जलिपुटौ करौ । कुचे चिबुकसंयोगान् नासिकाग्रं निरीक्षयेत् ॥ २९ ॥

IAST

urvoḥ kurparamādhāya kṛtāñjalipuṭau karau | kuce cibukasaṃyogān nāsikāgraṃ nirīkṣayet || 29 ||

Cyrillic transliteration

урвоҳ курпарамāдхāйа кр̣тāн̃джалипуṭау карау | куче чибукасаṃйогāн нāсикāграṃ нирӣкшайет || 29 ||

Devanāgarī

गरुडासनमेतद् वै सर्वसिद्धिकरं भवेत् । गुदेनापीड्य धरणीं पादाभ्यामपि च स्फुटम् ॥ ३० ॥

IAST

garuḍāsanametad vai sarvasiddhikaraṃ bhavet | gudenāpīḍya dharaṇīṃ pādābhyāmapi ca sphuṭam || 30 ||

Cyrillic transliteration

гарудāсанаметад ваи сарвасиддхикараṃ бхавет | гуденāпӣдйа дхараṇйṃ пāдāбхйāмапи ча спхуṭам || 30 ||

Word-by-word analysis

вāма-гулпхака-пр̣шṭхе - on the back of the left ankle; ту - same; дакша-гулпхам - right ankle; нидхāпайет - let him place it; пāтайитвā - lowering; махеш́āни - O Maheśānī; джāну-йугмаṃ - a pair of knees; махӣтале - to the ground.

ӯрвоḥ - on the hips; курпарам-āдхāйа - placing [the] elbow(s); the exact construction is uncertain; кр̣та-аñджали-пуṭау - añjali folded into a bowl; карау - hands; куче - on the chest (reading “कुचे” is not entirely reliable); чибука-саṃйогāт - thanks to the connection of the chin [with the chest]; нāсикā-аграṃ - tip of the nose; нирӣкшайет - let him contemplate.

гарудāсанам - Garuḍāsana; етат - this one; ваи - truly; сарва-сиддхи-караṃ - bestower of all siddhis; бхавет - becomes; гудена-āпӣдйа - pressing with/by the anus; the syntax and intended action remain uncertain (edition: “गुदेनापीड्य”); дхараṇйṃ - ground; пāдāбхйāм - both feet; апи ча - also; спхуṭам - obviously [pressing].

Literal translation

On the back of the left ankle let him place the right ankle and, O Maheśānī, lower both knees to the ground, placing the elbow or elbows on the thighs and joining the hands in a cupped añjali (the syntax of “कुर्परमाधाय” is uncertain), at the junction of the chin with the chest (the reading “कुचे” is not entirely reliable) let him contemplate the tip of the nose. This Garuḍāsana truly becomes the bestower of all siddhis: by [pressing with/by the anus; syntax uncertain] (edition: “गुदेनापीड्य”) and clearly pressing the feet with the ground.

Literary translation

Place the right ankle on the back of the left and lower both knees to the ground. Place the elbows on the thighs [the construction is uncertain] and join the hands in a cupped añjali. The reading interpreted as bringing the chin to the chest is also uncertain. Look towards the tip of the nose. The sense of gudenāpīḍya and its relationship to the feet and the ground remain uncertain. The posture is said to confer all siddhis.

Note: The edition reads कुर्परमाधाय in verse 29; its interpretation is uncertain; “कुचे” is not entirely reliable.

13. Yaksasana (“Yaksha Pose”)

Devanāgarī

जान्वोरू .....करौ स्थाप्यं स्थिरं देशे भवेद् दृढम् एतद् यक्षासनं सर्वविघ्नच्छेदस्य कारणम् ॥ ३१ ॥

IAST

jānvorū .....karau sthāpyaṃ sthiraṃ deśe bhaved dṛḍham etad yakṣāsanaṃ sarvavighnacchedasya kāraṇam || 31 ||

Cyrillic transliteration

джāнворӯ .....карау стхāпйаṃ стхираṃ деш́е бхавед дṛдҳам етад йакшāсанаṃ сарвавигхначчхедасйа кāраṇам || 31 ||

Word-by-word analysis

джāнв-ӯрӯ - on the knees and hips (read the beginning); (...lacuna in the manuscript...); карау - hands; стхāпйаṃ - should be placed; стхираṃ - resistant; деш́е - in [its] place; бхавед - becomes; дṛдҳам - strong; етат - this one; йакшāсанаṃ - Yakṣāsana; сарва-вигхна-ччхедасйа - cutting all obstacles; кāраṇам is the reason.

Literal translation

On the knees and hips... (lacuna in the manuscript) ... hands should be placed; [the posture] becomes stable and strong in [its] place. This Yakṣāsana is the cause of cutting through all obstacles.

Literary translation

The line contains a lacuna. The surviving words have been interpreted as placing the hands on the knees and thighs, but the gap makes this reconstruction uncertain. The posture is said to be firm and to remove all obstacles.

Note: In the middle of the verse there is a gap (dot in the manuscript): “जान्वोरू .....करौ”.

14. Siddhāsana (“Perfect Pose”)

Devanāgarī

उरुयुग्ममूलं पीठार्थं जंघा वाश्लिष्य पार्वति । पादयुक् (ग्म) पश्चिमौ (?) न्यस्य पर्यंकेन दृढं तनुम् ॥ ३२ ॥

IAST

uruyugmamūlaṃ pīṭhārthaṃ jaṃghā vāśliṣya pārvati | pādayuk (gma) paścimau (?) nyasya paryaṃkena dṛḍhaṃ tanum || 32 ||

Cyrillic transliteration

уруйугмамӯлаṃ пӣṭхāртхаṃ джаṃгхā вāш́лишйа пārвати | пādайук (гма) паш́чимау (?) нйасйа парйаṃкена дṛдҳаṃ танум || 32 ||

Devanāgarī

कमटी (?) मुद्रया मूले समवष्टभ्य यत्नतः । समदेहस्थिरो भूत्वा सिद्धासनमिदं परम् ॥ ३३ ॥

IAST

kamaṭī (?) mudrayā mūle samavaṣṭabhya yatnataḥ | samadehasthiro bhūtvā siddhāsanamidaṃ param || 33 ||

Cyrillic transliteration

камаṭӣ (?) мудрайā мӯле самавашṭабхйа йатнатаҳ | самадехастхиро бхӯтвā сиддхāсанамидаṃ парам || 33 ||

Devanāgarī

सर्वसिद्धिप्रदं देवि सर्वव्याधिविनाशनम् । जङ्घाभ्यामुरुयुग्मं च समाश्रित्य निपात्य च ॥ ३४ ॥

IAST

sarvasiddhipradaṃ devi sarvavyādhivināśanam | jaṅghābhyāmuruyugmaṃ ca samāśritya nipātya ca || 34 ||

Cyrillic transliteration

сарвасиддхипрадаṃ деви сарвавйādхивинāш́анам | джаṅгхāбхйāмуруйугмаṃ ча самāш́ритйа нипāтйа ча || 34 ||

Word-by-word analysis

уру-йугма-мӯлаṃ - root of a pair of hips; пӣṭхāртхаṃ - for the sake of support (seat); джаṅгхāṃ - lower leg (in the edition: “जंघा”); вā-ш́лишйа - grasping (reading unclear); пāрвати - O Pārvatī; пāда-йугмаṃ - both feet; паш́чимау (?) - [reading unclear]; нйасйа - placing; парйаṃкена - in the parian position (crossed legs); дṛдхаṃ - strong; танум - body; камаṭӣ (?) мудрайā - [unreadable]; мӯле - at the base; самавашṭабхйа - leaning; йатнатаḥ - with force.

сама-деха-стхираḥ - with a leveled body, stable; бхӯтвā - becoming; сиддхāсанам - Siddhāsana; идаṃ - this one; парам - highest.

сарва-сиддхи-прадаṃ - bestower of all siddhi; деви - O Goddess; сарва-вйāдхи-винāш́анам - destroying all diseases; джаṅгхāбхйāм - both shins; уру-йугмаṃ - a pair of hips; ча - and; самāш́ритйа - grasping (leaning); нипāтйа - lowering [body]; ча - and.

Literal translation

O Pārvatī, [making] the root of a pair of thighs a support (seat), clasping the lower leg (reading “वाश्लिष्य” is unclear), placing both feet... (reading “पश्चिमौ (?)” is unclear)... [having] a body firmly [built] in parian; ... (the beginning of the line “कमटी (?) मुद्रया” is difficult to interpret in the edition) ... at the base, leaning with effort, becoming stable with the body aligned, is the highest Siddhāsana. It bestows all siddhis, O Goddess, and destroys all diseases; clasping a pair of thighs with both shins and lowering himself [on them]...

Literary translation

The passage is difficult: “जंघा वाश्लिष्य”, “पश्चिमौ (?)” and “कमटी (?)” are uncertain. The Russian interpretation describes the roots of the thighs as a support and the body as upright and steady in a cross-legged position. The posture is said to confer all siddhis and destroy all diseases. The final line of verse 34 is interpreted as leading into the next posture.

Note: The readings "जंघा वाश्लिष्य", "पश्चिमौ (?)" and "कमटी (?) मुद्रया" in verses 32-33 are unclear; “कमटी” is left as in the manuscript.

15. Vrsabhāsana (“Bull Pose”)

Devanāgarī

कर्पूरंस्तं भवत्कृत्वा (?) पार्श्वेनैकेन संश्रयेत् । एतत् प्रोक्तं मया देवि वृषभासनमुत्तमम् ॥ ३५ ॥

IAST

karpūraṃstaṃ bhavatkṛtvā (?) pārśvenaikena saṃśrayet | etat proktaṃ mayā devi vṛṣabhāsanamuttamam || 35 ||

Cyrillic transliteration

карпӯраṃстаṃ бхаваткṛтвā (?) пāрш́венаикена саṃш́райет | етат проктаṃ майā деви вṛшабхāсанамуттамам || 35 ||

Word-by-word analysis

карпӯраṃстаṃ бхават-кṛтвā (?) - [unreadable]; пāрш́вена-екена - one side; саṃш́райет - let him cling (lean); етат is; проктаṃ - proclaimed; майā - by me; деви - O Goddess; вṛшабхāсанам - Vṛṣabhāsana; уттамам - highest.

Literal translation

… (the beginning of the verse in the edition is difficult to interpret: “कर्पूरंस्तं भवत्कृत्वा (?)”) … let him cling to one side. This, O Goddess, is declared by me to be the highest Vṛṣabhāsana.

Literary translation

The beginning of the description is unclear (“कर्पूरंस्तं भवत्कृत्वा (?)”); the surviving words are interpreted as “let him lean on one side.” Śiva declares this to be the supreme Vṛṣabhāsana.

Note: The beginning of verse 35 (“कर्पूरंस्तं भवत्कृत्वा (?)”) is difficult to interpret in the edition.

Application. Concluding verses of the Paṭala (36–46)

These verses complete the āsana section: the general benefits of āsanas, the choice of one pose, the conditions of the place and time of practice, the gradualness of the exercise. Presented in an abbreviated format (without word-by-word analysis). Unclear passages have been left as in the manuscript.

Devanāgarī

सर्वरोगविघातार्थं प्रोक्तमेतन्महात्मभिः । एषा चान्ये च बहवो ह्यासना (नि) योगसिद्धिदाः ॥ ३६ ॥

IAST

sarvarogavighātārthaṃ proktametanmahātmabhiḥ | eṣā cānye ca bahavo hyāsanā (ni) yogasiddhidāḥ || 36 ||

Cyrillic transliteration

сарварогавигхāтāртхаṃ проктаметанмахāтмабхиḥ | ешā чāнйе ча бахаво хйāсанā (ни) йогасиддхидāḥ || 36 ||

Translation

For the sake of eliminating all diseases [these postures] are proclaimed by great souls; this and many other āsanas (in the edition: “आसना (नि)”) bestow perfection in yoga.

Devanāgarī

यथाम्यासं यथायोगं तेषामेकतरं भजेत् । स सिद्धे ह्यासने सम्यक् सर्वेन्द्रियवशीकरम् ॥ ३७ ॥

IAST

yathāmyāsaṃ yathāyogaṃ teṣāmekataraṃ bhajet | sa siddhe hyāsane samyak sarvendriyavaśīkaram || 37 ||

Cyrillic transliteration

йатхāмйāсаṃ йатхāйогаṃ тешāмекатараṃ бхаджет | са сиддхе хйāсане самйак сарвендрийаваш́йкарам || 37 ||

Translation

According to [his] practice (in the edition: “यथाम्यासं”) and [his] yoga, let him choose one of them; in perfect āsana [she] duly subordinates all the senses.

Devanāgarī

भविष्यति दृढकायं मनोनिश्चलता तथा । अभ्यस्ते नासने नैव समासीनो दिवानिशम् ॥ ३८ ॥

IAST

bhaviṣyati dṛḍhakāyaṃ manoniścalatā tathā | abhyaste nāsane naiva samāsīno divāniśam || 38 ||

Cyrillic transliteration

бхавишйати дрдхакāйаṃ манониш́чалатā татхā | абхйасте нāсане наива самāсйно дивāниш́ам || 38 ||

Translation

There will be a strong body and steadfast mind (reading “दृढकायं” is unclear); staying in the practiced āsana (in the edition: “नासने नैव” - reading unclear), [the yogi sits] day and night.

Devanāgarī

योगं युञ्जीत विजने निःशब्दे जन्तुवर्जिते । सुसमे च सुसम्पृष्ठे गन्धधूपादिवासिते ॥ ३९ ॥

IAST

yogaṃ yuñjīta vijane niḥśabde jantuvarjite | susame ca susampṛṣṭhe gandhadhūpādivāsite || 39 ||

Cyrillic transliteration

йогаṃ йун̃джӣта виджане ниḥш́абде джантуварджите | сусаме ча сусампр̣шт̣хе гандхадхӯпāдивāсите || 39 ||

Translation

Let him practise yoga in a deserted, silent place, devoid of living creatures, completely flat (in the edition: “सुसम्पृष्ठे”), fragrant with aromas, incense, etc.

Devanāgarī

शिवाश्रमे गुह्यस्थाने गृहे वापि विविक्तके । श्री परामृतसंतृप्तचेतनो नियतात्मवान् ॥ ४० ॥

IAST

śivāśrame guhyasthāne gṛhe vāpi viviktake | śrī parāmṛtasaṃtṛptacetano niyatātmavān || 40 ||

Cyrillic transliteration

ш́ивāш́раме гухйастхāне грхе вāпи вивиктаке | ш́рӣ парāмр̣тасаṃтр̣птачетано нийатāтмавāн || 40 ||

Translation

[Practices] in the abode of Śiva, in a secret place or in a secluded house; with a consciousness saturated with the highest nectar (the reading of “श्री” is unclear), with a subdued soul.

Devanāgarī

अभ्यसेदनिशं योगी सर्वसिद्ध्यर्थमादरा (त्) । एकाग्रमतिरव्यग्रस्तत् प्रमाण (म्) सुनिश्चयः ॥ ४१ ॥

IAST

abhyasedaniśaṃ yogī sarvasiddhyarthamādarā (t) | ekāgramatiravyagrastat pramāṇa (m) suniścayaḥ || 41 ||

Cyrillic transliteration

абхйаседаниш́аṃ йогӣ сарвасиддхйартхамādарā (т) | екāграматиравйаграстат прамāṇа (м) суниш́чайаḥ || 41 ||

Translation

Let the yogi practice tirelessly for the sake of all siddhis, with reverence (in the edition: “आदरा (त्)”); with a one-pointed mind, undistracted, quite confident in the [correct] measure of that [exercise] (in the edition: “प्रमाण (म्)”).

Devanāgarī

नित्योद्युक्तः सदोत्साही गुरुवानमृताशयः । मृदघटादि (?) र्निशं योगी सर्वसिद्ध्यर्थमादग्रे ॥ ४२ ॥

IAST

nityodyuktaḥ sadotsāhī guruvānamṛtāśayaḥ | mṛdaghaṭādi (?) rniśaṃ yogī sarvasiddhayarthamādagre || 42 ||

Cyrillic transliteration

нитйодйуктаḥ садотсāхӣ гурувāнамṛтāш́айаḥ | мṛдагхаṭāди (?) рниш́аṃ йогӣ сарвасиддхайартхамāдагре || 42 ||

Translation

Always diligent, always enthusiastic, having a guru, yearning for nectar, - ... (reading "मृदघटादि (?) र्निशं... आदग्रे" in the manuscript is unclear) ....

Devanāgarī

..... विभेदेन भवेदुत्साहयोगतः तथा भवति देहो (S) यमभ्यासेन तु योगिनः । सहसा नाभ्यसेद् योगं शनैः सम्यक् तमाचरेत् ॥ ४३ ॥

IAST

..... vibhedena bhavedutsāhayogataḥ tathā bhavati deho (S) yamabhyāsena tu yoginaḥ | sahasā nābhyased yogaṃ śanaiḥ samyak tamācaret || 43 ||

Cyrillic transliteration

..... вибхедена бхаведутсāхайогатаḥ татхā бхавати дехо (С) йамабхйāсена ту йогинаḥ | сахасā нāбхйасед йогаṃ ш́анаиḥ самйак тамāчарет || 43 ||

Translation

The first half of the verse in the manuscript is damaged (only individual words are readable: “विभेदेन”, “उत्साहयोगतः”, “देहो (S)”, “यमभ्यासेन”). The second half is clear: “Yoga should not be practiced suddenly; let him do it gradually, properly.”

Devanāgarī

युगपत्सेवितो दोषान् करोति बहूंस्तनौ । तस्मादभ्यासयोगेन शनैर्योगश्च सिद्धयति ॥ ४४ ॥

IAST

yugapatsevito doṣān karoti bahūṃstanau | tasmādabhyāsayogena śanairyogaśca siddhayati || 44 ||

Cyrillic transliteration

йугапатсевито дошāн кароти бахӯṃстанау | тасмāдабхйāсайогена ш́анаирйогаш́ча сиддхайати || 44 ||

Translation

Practiced at once [too hastily], [yoga] creates many defects in the body; Therefore, through gradual practice, yoga achieves perfection.

Devanāgarī

एककालं द्विकालं वा त्रिकालं वापि पार्वति । सर्वविघ्नप्रशान्त्यर्थं भूतेभ्यो बलिमाहरेत् । अन्यथा बहुना (बहून्) विघ्नान् कुर्वन्ति परमेश्वरि ॥ ४५ ॥

IAST

ekakālaṃ dvikālaṃ vā trikālaṃ vāpi pārvati | sarvavighnapraśāntyarthaṃ bhūtebhyo balimāharet | anyathā bahunā (bahūn) vighnān kurvanti parameśvari || 45 ||

Cyrillic transliteration

екакāлаṃ двикāлаṃ вā трикāлаṃ вāпи пāрвати | сарвавигхнапраш́āнтйартхаṃ бхӯтебхйо балимāхарет | анйатхā бахунā (бахӯн) вигхнāн курванти парамеш́вари || 45 ||

Translation

Once [a day], twice or thrice, O Pārvatī, for the sake of pacifying all obstacles, let him offer sacrifice (bali) to the spirits; otherwise they, O Supreme Lady, create many obstacles (in the edition: “बहुना (बहू)”).

Devanāgarī

स्नानादिभिः शुद्धतनुः स्वदेहे, विशोषदाह.....वनादिकृत्वा । अद्यापि संततमतिः प्रवरासनानि, संसिद्धिमेति ब (?) चिराय महेश योगी ॥ ४६ ॥

IAST

snānādibhiḥ śuddhatanuḥ svadehe, viśoṣadāha.....vanādikṛtvā | adyāpi saṃtatamatiḥ pravarāsanāni, saṃsiddhimeti ba (?) cirāya maheśa yogī || 46 ||

Cyrillic transliteration

снāнāдибхиḥ ш́уддхатануḥ свадехе, виш́ошадāха.....ванāдикр̣твā | адйāпи саṃтатаматиḥ праварāсанāни, саṃсиддхимети ба (?) чирāйа махеш́а йогӣ || 46 ||

Translation

With the body purified by ablutions, etc., … (missing in the edition: “विशोषदाह.....वनादिकृत्वा”) … the yogi with a constant mind [thanks to] the most excellent āsanas, O Mahesha, eventually achieves perfection (the reading of “संसिद्धिमेति ब (?)” is unclear).

Notes on manuscript readings

Numbering of verses. The numbering is in order 1–46; Between verses 17 and 18 there is an additional verse 18a (repeating the first line of verse 17).

The principle of working with damaged areas. Corrupt and unreadable passages of the manuscript are left as in the manuscript (without speculation): they are marked with “(?)”, variants in parentheses or ellipses, and are listed in the notes below.

Verse 2. The middle of the line is missing in the manuscript; reading “वासोत्तरं छदम्” is not reliable, “दक्षिणं/दक्षिणे” is duplicated.

Verse 3. “सम-ग्रीवशिरोव (कुत्रं) ह (स्तौ)” – the reading is corrupt; “गुदमेकाग्रो” is written together.

Verse 9. The form "मवष्टभ्य" is left as in the manuscript.

Verse 10. “स्थानाग्रे” – lit. “at the forefront of [its] place”; the meaning is unclear.

Verse 11. The word “पृच्छनुचम्य (?)” is not read.

Verse 14. “दानमिततनु” is not read; "मानमः (° मानसः)" is doubled.

Verses 17–18 (18a). The lines “उरुभ्यामुपरि…” and “ऋजुग्रीवशिरो…” are partially repeated - the text in the manuscript is duplicated (an additional verse 18a is placed between verses 17 and 18); readings "त्यज्य (न्यस्य ?)", "दक्ष्यास्य (दक्षस्यास्य)", "अजु (ऋजु)" fluctuate.

Verse 25. the meaning of “कर्पूरे (कुपरे)” is uncertain; "अङ्गुलीतल-गोपिता" and "अङ्गुलीपृष्ठयो हेतु" are unreliable.

Verse 29. “कुर्परमाधाय” – the reading is unclear; “कुचे” is not entirely reliable.

Verse 31. The gap in the middle: “जान्वोरू .....करौ.”

Verse 32. “जंघा वाश्लिष्य”, “पश्चिमौ (?)”, “कमटी (?)” - readings are unclear; the line "कमटी (?) मुद्रया…" is adjacent to verse 32 in the manuscript.

Verse 35. “कर्पूरंस्तं भवत्कृत्वा (?)” – cannot be read.

Verse 39. The 1994 edition reads योगं युञ्जीत; the article’s गंजीत is a transcription error.

Verses 42-43, 46. Corrupted in places; Translated only from clearly legible fragments.

Name "श्वलिकासन". The title is damaged in the manuscript (“श्वलिका (?) - सन”); in Paṭala's summary in the publication she is listed as Svastikāsana.

The translation and word-by-word analysis are based on the handwritten transcription of Paṭala III of the Matsyendra Saṃhitā.

Matsyendra Saṃhitā · III Paṭala ·